

GHOSTBUSTERS, VIRGINIA

P.K.E.

INSTRUCTION MANUAL



FOR 1 PLAYER

16

GAMES

ECTO-GAMES

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Based on characters created by Dan Aykroyd and Harold Ramis.

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NOTE: Always turn the console POWER switch OFF when inserting or removing an ATARI® Game Program™ cartridge. This will protect the electronic components and prolong the life of your ATARI® Video Computer System™ game.

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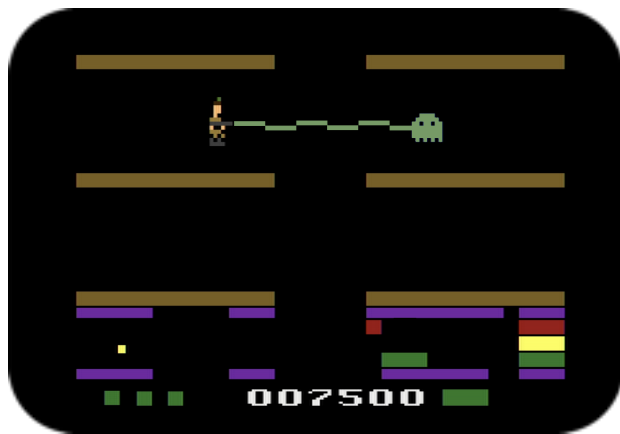
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## P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

### 1. INTRODUCTION

*"If there's something strange in the neighborhood, who ya gonna call?"*

*— Ray Parker, Jr.*



The neighborhood library has a nasty case of spooks, specters, and ghosts haunting the stacks. It's your job, as head of the city's foremost Professional Paranormal Investigation and Elimination Service, to capture the ghosts without sliming all your uniforms!

### 2. USING THE CONTROLLERS

*"We have the tools! We have the talent!" — Winston Zeddemore*



Use the Joystick Controller with this ATARI® Game Program™ cartridge. Be sure the Joystick Controller cable is firmly plugged into the LEFT CONTROLLER jack at the back of your ATARI® Video Computer System™.



## P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

Hold the Joystick with the red button to your upper left, toward the television screen.

Move the joystick up, down, left, or right to maneuver the player on the screen. Avoid the ghosts and collect the bonuses. Press the FIRE button to blast your neutrona wand.

### 3. CONSOLE CONTROLS

*"Very simple, really. Loaded trap here. Open. Unlock the system. Insert the trap. Release. Close. Lock the system. Set your entry grid. Neutronize your field. And, when the light is green, the trap is clean." — Dr. Ray Stantz*

After powering on your ATARI® Video Computer System™, you will see the title card and hear the theme music.

Press FIRE once to skip ahead to the Game Select Screen.

Depress the Game Select switch to choose the game variation. The game variation number is displayed at the bottom of the screen.



Press the FIRE button to begin the selected game.

Sixteen game variations are available. Refer to the GAME SELECT MATRIX.

## P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

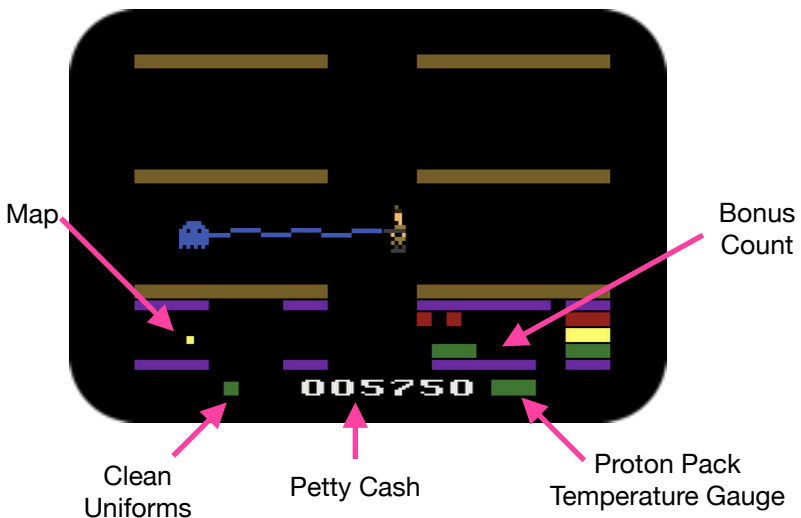
### 4. GAME PLAY

*"Why worry? Each of us is wearing an unlicensed nuclear accelerator on his back."*  
— Dr. Peter Venkman

You are searching the library for ghosts. The Easy Layout is the main floor of the library, with everything in neat orderly rows. The Complex Layout takes you to the basement, where things are a bit more maze-like.

If the map is enabled, it appears at the left of the display. The blinking dot indicates position within the library.

On the main floor (EASY LAYOUT), all the bookshelves run east-west with gaps allowing movement in any of the four directions. However, in the basement (COMPLEX LAYOUT), shelves may also run north-south and some paths are blocked.



## ***P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS***

Below the map is a count of clean uniforms. Contact with a ghost results in being slimed. When all four uniforms are slimed, the game is over.

In the bottom center of the panel is your petty cash balance.

When you enter a screen with a ghost, find a position where you can safely fire your wand without making contact with the ghost.

The ghost weakens when struck by the stream from your neutrona wand. The ghost's color fades to white and then gray.

Maintain your stream on the ghost until it is weak enough to be trapped, at which point your ghost trap will automatically self-deploy.

Monitor the pack temperature when firing the neutrona wand. The temperature gauge, an eight-segment bar graph, displays to the right of the petty cash display.

Firing the wand causes the pack to heat up due to the generation of proton energy. The pack cools when not being fired.

A green temperature gauge indicates safe operation. A yellow gauge indicates crossing the 50% threshold. A red gauge, and an audible alarm, indicates the pack has overheated.

Once an overheat condition occurs, the neutrona wand is inoperable until the pack completely cools. Overheating the pack results in an expensive repair (see SCORING), but it's better than a meltdown of the fuel cells!

## 5. GHOST BEHAVIOR

*"Sir, what you had there was what we refer to as a Focused, Non-Terminal, Repeating Phantasm, or a Class V Full-Roaming Vapor. A real nasty one, too." — Dr. Ray Stantz*

Five classes of ghost are found in the library, differing in four characteristics:

- Strength: resistance to the neutrona stream
- Temperament: fear of humans
- Movement: likelihood to change path
- Manifestation: duration of presence in a particular spot

| Class                                                                                 | Strength   | Temperament | Movement  | Manifestation |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------------|-----------|---------------|
|  I   | Weak       | Timid       | Steady    | Lingers       |
|  II  | Resilient  | Skittish    | Unsettled | Patient       |
|  III | Formidable | Wary        | Agitated  | Restless      |
|  IV | Intense    | Bold        | Chaotic   | Transient     |
|  V | Relentless | Brazen      | Possessed | Fleeting      |

## 6. SNACK AND BONUS ITEMS

*"Well, let's say this Twinkie represents the normal amount of psychokinetic energy in the New York area. Based on this morning's sample, it would be a Twinkie thirty-five feet long, weighing approximately six hundred pounds."*

— Dr. Egon Spengler

Seven snack items and one very important book have been placed in the library. Collecting these will earn cash (see SCORING) and upgrades (see HOW TO USE THE P.K.E. METER).

| Tier 1                                                                            |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   | Tier 2                                                                            |                                                                                   |                                                                                   | Tier 3                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |

Tier 1: Basic snacks include a ***pink donut***, a ***mug of coffee*** ("Yes, have some!"), an ***ECTO Cooler juice box***, and ***Cheez-it Crackers***.

Tier 2: Advanced snacks include the ***Nestlé Crunch bar*** ("You've earned it!"), ***Hostess Twinkie***, and a ***Stay-Puft marshmallow***.

Tier 3 is the foundational reference book for any paranormal hunter, ***Tobin's Spirit Guide***.

## ***P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS***

### **7. SCORING**

*"No job is too big, no fee is too big" — Dr. Peter Venkman*

Earn cash for capturing ghosts and locating bonus items. Pay for repairs after overheating the pack.

| <b><i>Ghost Trapping</i></b> |                |
|------------------------------|----------------|
| Ghost Class                  | Fee Collected  |
| Class I                      | <b>\$500</b>   |
| Class II                     | <b>\$1,000</b> |
| Class III                    | <b>\$1,500</b> |
| Class IV                     | <b>\$2,500</b> |
| Class V                      | <b>\$5,000</b> |

| <b><i>Penalties</i></b> |                |
|-------------------------|----------------|
| Event                   | Repair Cost    |
| Pack Overheats          | <b>\$1,000</b> |

| <b><i>Bonuses</i></b>      |              |                                   |                |
|----------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------|----------------|
| Item                       | Bonus Earned | Item                              | Bonus Earned   |
| Pink Donut                 | <b>\$250</b> | Crunch Bar                        | <b>\$500</b>   |
| Mug of Coffee              | <b>\$250</b> | Twinkie                           | <b>\$500</b>   |
| Ecto Cooler                | <b>\$250</b> | Stay-Puft Marshmallow             | <b>\$500</b>   |
| Cheez-Its                  | <b>\$250</b> | Tobin's Spirit Guide              | <b>\$1,000</b> |
| Collect all 7 snacks again |              | <b>A clean uniform or \$7,500</b> |                |

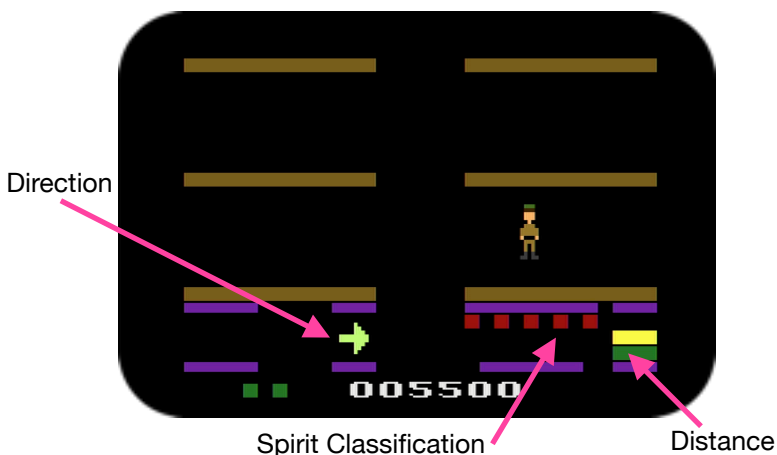
## P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

### 8. HOW TO USE THE P.K.E. METER

*"Spengler went down there and took some P.K.E. readings. Right off the top of the scale! Buried the needle!" — Dr. Ray Stantz*

The Psychokinetic Energy (P.K.E.) Meter is the primary detection and ranging device to locate ghosts, and its readout takes up most of the bottom of the screen.

On the right side is the distance readout. The meter senses energy being given off by a paranormal entity. As paranormal energy increases, the meter becomes increasingly reactive. Beeps and lights indicate the range.



Once four bonus snacks have been collected, the Spirit Classification display will show one to five lights, to indicate the ghost's class. This is only visible when you are within one screen of the ghost. Upon locating Tobin's Spirit Guide, the P.K.E. meter will also have the ability to point the general direction to the ghost.

## P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

| Feedback                                                                            | Meaning                                               | Availability                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
|     | No audio<br>The ghost is three or more screens away   | From game start                    |
|     | Slow blink and beep<br>The ghost is two screens away  |                                    |
|     | Medium blink and beep<br>The ghost is one screen away |                                    |
|     | Fast blink and beep<br>The ghost is on the screen.    |                                    |
| <hr/>                                                                               |                                                       |                                    |
|    | The ghost is this class, from I to V                  | After locating four snacks         |
| <hr/>                                                                               |                                                       |                                    |
|  | The ghost is generally in this direction              | After finding Tobin's Spirit Guide |



## **9. GAME VARIATIONS**

*"Human sacrifice, dogs and cats living together... mass hysteria!"*  
— Dr. Peter Venkman

The difficulty ramps up as you go through the sixteen game variations, based on combinations of these game elements:

### **Layout:**

The game will either be played in the Easy Layout (main level) or Complex Layout (basement).

### **Bonus Item Placement:**

Bonus items will either be placed in the same, predefined location, or randomly distributed for the first cycle.

Note that once the Tobin's Spirit Guide has been found, the snacks will ***always*** be randomly placed.

### **Locator Map:**

The locator map either be available or will remain off for play, requiring you to keep track of your location entirely by memory.

### **P.K.E. Direction Arrow:**

The direction sensor is enabled after locating Tobin's Spirit Guide in some variations, but in others, even locating the book will not make this sensor work.

See the GAME SELECT MATRIX for determine which combination of settings is turned on for a particular variation.

## P.K.E. INSTRUCTIONS

### 10. HELPFUL HINTS

*"Okay, important safety tip. Thanks, Egon." — Dr. Peter Venkman*

**Ghosts don't hang around.** If you exit a screen a ghost is on, it likely won't be there when you come back.

**Always have an escape strategy.** If the ghost slimes you, you're out, so be ready to run away and bust another day.

**Move closer after you stun the ghost.** Your stream is more effective at weakening the ghost the closer you are.

**Distance is as the ghost flies.** The P.K.E. Distance Meter shows absolute distance. The ghost may be one screen *diagonally*, which takes two screens to get to.

**Whoa! Nice shootin', Tex...** Reflected energy from hitting a wall will cause your pack to overheat even faster than normal.

**When you're hot, you're hot!** Ghosts become brave when they can tell your pack is disabled. Be careful.

**Retrace your steps.** Bonus items are not all visible from the start, but appear in a sequence. Locate the four tier 1 snacks (donut, coffee, ECTO Cooler, and Cheez-Its) first. This unlocks the tier 2 snacks (Crunch Bar, Twinkie, and Stay-Puft Marshmallow). Collect those three, and you'll finally have a chance to read Tobin's Spirit Guide!

**Keep Snacking!** Finding the Spirit Guide completes your inventory, but your work isn't done. The seven snacks are spread through the library again. Finding them again to earn either a clean uniform or (if you have the full complement) a cash bonus of **\$7,500**.

## 12. GAME SELECT MATRIX

| Game No.                    | 1      | 2     | 3      | 4      | 5      | 6    | 7      | 8      | 9      | 10    | 11     | 12     | 13     | 14  | 15     | 16     |
|-----------------------------|--------|-------|--------|--------|--------|------|--------|--------|--------|-------|--------|--------|--------|-----|--------|--------|
| Easy Layout                 | Blue   | Blue  | Blue   | Blue   | Blue   | Blue | Blue   | Blue   |        |       |        |        |        |     |        |        |
| Complex Layout              |        |       |        |        |        |      |        |        | Red    | Red   | Red    | Red    | Red    | Red | Red    | Red    |
| Locator Map                 | Green  | Green | Green  | Green  |        |      |        |        | Green  | Green | Green  | Green  |        |     |        |        |
| Random Bonus Item Placement |        |       | Yellow | Yellow |        |      | Yellow | Yellow |        |       | Yellow | Yellow |        |     | Yellow | Yellow |
| PKE Direction Arrow*        | Purple |       | Purple |        | Purple |      | Purple |        | Purple |       | Purple |        | Purple |     | Purple |        |

\* After locating Tobin's Spirit Guide

**P.K.E.**

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